

If you are recording something then you need to use the microphone to record audio into Audacity. If you notice, the default selection in Audacity is the microphone. For recording, here's what you need to do.

Place your microphone close to your instrument. Make sure it isn't in your way while you're playing. To record, press the round red button, which is similar in almost all recording programs for computers.

You will not see the waveform while recording, but you will be able to monitor the amplitude. If it is getting close to the top and bottom of the panel, (1.0 and -1.0) lower the microphone volume using the slider with a microphone picture by it. If it is very thin, without getting near the "0.5 and -0.5" at the loudest points, you may need to raise the volume a little. When done, click on the square stop button. On playback the waveform will appear.

Once the recording is finished, click the Play button and it will play the music you just recorded. The next thing is to remove the blank space at the beginning and end of the recording. For now, trim to the approximate size (take care to not trim too much since you can set the start and end points more precisely with the 'Cut' tool later). Just place the mouse cursor right before the spot from where the music starts. Now holding the left mouse button down drag to the right, the waveform background will darken where you are dragging because you are selecting this area. When you get to the end of the music release the mouse button and go to Edit and click on it. Selecting 'trim' will remove the sections before and after the selected area.

Listen to the edited track so you know that you didn't cut it too short and if you did, don't worry, you can always undo what you did by clicking on 'Undo' under 'Edit' in the menu.

Now to save the music file, go to **File > Save project as**, or if you want to save it as a WAV file, '**Export as WAV**'. It will then let